

Maritime Gateway



■ **Shri P L Haranadh**
Chairman
Paradip Port Authority

Paradip Port achieved a milestone as India's top cargo-handling port in FY2024–25. Could you share the key performance highlights from the last fiscal year, including overall cargo volume, major commodities, and leading clients?

Paradip Port made history by becoming India's first major port to cross **150 million metric tonnes (MMT)** in cargo handling, retaining its position as the **No. 1 cargo-handling port** for the second consecutive year.

This milestone reflects our strategic growth, robust industry partnerships, and best-in-class operations. With a **9% CAGR over three years**, the highest berth productivity nationally, and handling nearly **one-third of India's coastal cargo**, Paradip Port continues to lead India's maritime growth story.

Our superior infrastructure and seamless hinterland connectivity are setting new benchmarks and shaping the future of Indian logistics.

What is the cargo handling target for FY2025–26, and what strategic initiatives are underway to meet stakeholder expectations?

Building on last year's success, Paradip Port has set an ambitious target of **over 160 MMT** for FY2025–26. To achieve this, we are expanding our coastal shipping network, enhancing multimodal logistics connectivity, and accelerating digital transformation through our **Smart Port roadmap** to ensure faster, smarter, and transparent operations. A key development is the westward expansion of coastal coal shipping to Maharashtra and Gujarat power plants, reflecting rising demand and a shift toward greener logistics.

In April, we hosted a stakeholder meet to align operational goals and strategies. We continue to offer the **lowest port handling charges**, frozen until 2026, along with volume-based incentives and berth performance rewards — all designed to attract more cargo and improve service delivery.

How is Paradip Port leveraging technology to boost efficiency and ease of doing business?

Paradip Port is advancing toward a next-generation **Smart Port** with key digital initiatives such as the **Enterprise Business System (EBS)**, **National Logistics Portal (NLP-Marine)**, and **Sparsh** — which enhance efficiency, transparency, and speed.

We handle the highest volume of financial transactions on NLP-Marine among all major ports and are the first to pilot an **AI-based yard and storage management system**. Additionally, our soon-to-be-completed, state-of-the-art **signal station** powered by an indigenous **VTMIS** system will optimize vessel traffic management, ensuring smoother and safer navigation.

With a 111% year-on-year increase in container throughput, what are the port's next steps to capture higher containerized cargo volumes? What frameworks are in place to facilitate further private participation?

We've seen a phenomenal **111% growth in container throughput**, driven by focused cargo diversification and a strong container ecosystem.

Our 5 MTPA clean cargo and container terminal under PPP has improved efficiency and reliability. We offer the lowest **Vessel Related Charges (VRCs)** among Indian ports, with discounts up to 75% for container vessels, plus free container scanning to reduce costs and turnaround times.

The operational **Multimodal Logistics Park** by CONCOR further integrates rail, road, and port services, boosting container handling. Plans are underway to add more **Container Freight Stations (CFSS)** to strengthen cargo aggregation.

Strategic connectivity has improved with direct MSC services from Colombo, positioning Paradip as a premier East Coast gateway. We're also developing a new **2 lakh TEU container berth** under PPP, with tendering in advanced stages to support